

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION

Preparation of the 11th Consultation

Combating discrimination in education

Eleventh consultation of Member States on the application of the Convention and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960) (2024-2025)

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION

1. Introduction

The Convention against Discrimination in Education (“the Convention”) and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (“the Recommendation”), adopted by UNESCO’s General Conference in 1960, are aligned with UNESCO’s constitutional mandate to “advance the ideal of equality of educational opportunities without regard to race, sex or any distinctions, economic or social”. The Convention is the first legally binding international instrument focused on the **right to education** and the only one exclusively dedicated to it.

The right to education is one of the key principles underpinning the Education 2030 agenda and Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4) adopted by the international community in 2015. SDG 4 seeks to ensure the full enjoyment of the right to education as fundamental to achieving sustainable development. Its scope captures the multidimensional nature of the right to education.

Representing a powerful tool to advance SDG 4 by ensuring effective articulation between normative and operational work, the Convention has been recognized as a cornerstone of Education 2030 agenda.

The present Guidelines are intended to assist Member States in the preparation of country reports on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation in the context of the 11th consultation.

2. Scope of the Consultation

Considering the Education 2030 agenda, the monitoring of the Convention and the Recommendation is of crucial importance to ensure an education that is truly inclusive for all and to counter persistent inequalities in access, participation and learning outcomes at all levels, particularly for the most vulnerable groups. This is particularly true under the current context in which countries are making efforts to recover from the learning disruption caused by the COVID-19 pandemic. Concrete measures taken by countries in accordance with their legal obligations under these instruments contribute to implementing the Education 2030 agenda.

As the scope and content of the legal obligations under the right to education are aligned with the 10 targets of SDG 4, efforts are being made to ensure that the components of the targets are included in the guidelines and that these guidelines serve as a valuable contribution to monitoring progress towards SDG 4 targets.

Beyond SDG 4, the Convention is also closely aligned with the normative content on the right to education of other international human rights instruments such as the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966), Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of

Discrimination against Women (1979), the Convention on the Rights of the Child (1989) and the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (2006).

In addition, this Consultation is an opportunity to inform the ongoing **UNESCO Initiative on the Evolving Right to Education within a lifelong learning perspective**¹ (launched in December 2021). The Initiative investigates how the right to education could be reinforced placing it within a lifelong learning perspective and in light of the new demands being placed on education. This Initiative builds on the **Report from the International Commission on the Futures of Education**², which suggests to broaden our understanding of the right to education to clearly apply it to all ages and across all times and spaces. The initiative is also in-line with the **Vision Statement of the United Nations Secretary General on Transforming Education**³, and the **Report on the 2022 Transforming Education Summit**⁴ which call for the transformation of education systems to 'include everyone, regardless of circumstance, context or background'. The Initiative on the Evolving Right to Education aims to open a collaborative and participatory discussion about the international framework to ensure the effective enforcement of the right to education and learning throughout life for all. Finally, the Initiative builds on recent inter-governmental dialogues, including the Marrakech Framework for Action for Adult Learning and Education⁵ and the Tashkent Declaration on Early Childhood Care and Education.⁶

It is also important to note that previous consultations on the Convention and Recommendation revealed that countries now understand the right to education in an extended manner. The 11th consultation builds on the findings of the previous national reports to include various areas that have direct repercussions on the right to education such as, for instance, digital learning, climate considerations, lifelong learning entitlement, and the role of non-state actors in education.

3. Reporting obligations

There are differences in the legal nature of the obligations under the Convention, as distinguished from those under the Recommendation. The Convention has binding force and the States Parties are under the obligation to incorporate its provisions into their domestic frameworks. The Recommendation, non-binding in nature, has political and moral force. Its adoption sought to take into account the difficulties that certain States might experience in ratifying the Convention, in particular with respect to their federal structure.

Bearing in mind the differences in legal scope inherent to the nature of these two categories of instruments, the content of the Recommendation is identical to that of the Convention. Member States are expected to give effect to it in national legislation and education policies.

The reporting obligation under the provisions of Article VII of the Convention and of the Recommendation is the same. Article VIII of UNESCO's Constitution states that "*Each Member State shall submit to the Organization, at such times and in such manner as shall be determined by the General Conference, reports on the laws, regulations and statistics relating to its educational, scientific and cultural institutions and activities, and on the action taken upon the recommendations and conventions referred to in Article IV, paragraph 4*". Therefore, even if a country is not a State Party to the Convention, it needs to submit a report on the implementation of the Recommendation, which means that **all UNESCO Member States are expected to submit a national report** on the implementation of these instruments in the context of monitoring consultations.

¹ <https://www.unesco.org/en/right-education/evolving>

² <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379707>

³ https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/2022/09/sg_vision_statement_on_transforming_education.pdf

⁴ https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/report_on_the_2022_transforming_education_summit.pdf

⁵ [Marrakech Framework for Action | Institute for Lifelong Learning \(unesco.org\)](https://www.unesco.org/en/marrakech-framework-for-action)

⁶ [Tashkent-declaration-ecce-2022.pdf \(unesco.org\)](https://www.unesco.org/en/tashkent-declaration-ecce-2022)

4. Participation in consultations

The reporting period for the 11th consultation on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation covers four years (2021-2024).

The Futures of Education Report calls for a new social contract for education, which requires to understand education as a common good and a shared societal endeavour. To ensure this, extensive consultations involving a broad range of stakeholders is needed. The reporting process therefore needs to be **participatory**. This includes ensuring cooperation between ministries of education and other ministries dealing with aspects of the right to education as well as consulting social partners and **civil society organizations** and other relevant bodies.

The preparation of national reports provides a **good opportunity** for Member States to assess the implementation of the right to education in their country, identify specific challenges, build constructive dialogue with other actors involved in this field and share good practices.

In the preparation of reports, Member States are encouraged to provide **substantive and relevant information in a concise manner**. In addition to a description of the constitutional, legislative, administrative, and policy framework established for the implementation of the provisions guaranteed by the instruments, the information supplied by Member States should demonstrate how legal norms and practices comply with the Convention and the Recommendation.

Relevant information supplied for other reporting instances may be reproduced or referred to with precise indication as to its retrieval. Similarly, hyperlinks to any useful documents or relevant legal and policy texts are most welcome and texts can also be added in the annex.

Country reports submitted for previous consultations can be found on the **Observatory on the right to education**⁷ in the monitoring section of the country profile. The information provided in the reports are valuable both for the Observatory on the right to education as well as for **HerAtlas**⁸, the online monitoring tool for girls' and women's right to education. Information and data regarding countries' education systems are also available through the UNESCO Institute for Statistics database⁹. Beyond monitoring purposes, the consultation findings and reports inform broader work - serving for knowledge generation, advocacy, and technical cooperation.

5. Modalities and structure

The Guidelines are structured around three chapters:

- The **first chapter** covers general information on adherence to the Convention.
- The **second chapter** aims to gather information on the implementation of the Convention and Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4. As the most extensive part of the Guidelines, this chapter covers: inclusion and non-discrimination in education (section 1), all levels and forms of education (section 2), quality education provision and learning environment (section 3) and finally, strengthening governance systems (section 4).
- The **third chapter** seeks to obtain information on the methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments.

With a view to simplify the Guidelines while providing necessary substantive information to assist Member States in the preparation of responses, through a participatory process, **two types of guidance** are provided:

⁷ <http://www.unesco.org/education/edurights/index.php?action=home&lng=en>

⁸ <https://en.unesco.org/education/girls-women-rights>

⁹ [UIS Statistics \(unesco.org\)](https://uis.unesco.org)

- (1) Open-ended and closed-ended questions to be directly filled in by Member States. Please note that multiple answers may be provided where relevant.
- (2) Additional information aimed at guiding Members States to structure and detail their responses to the open-ended questions (including remarks on how to respond efficiently to the questions raised). These elements are presented in italics.

GENERAL INFORMATION:

Country name: Bosnia and Herzegovina

Organization or entity responsible for the preparation of the report: Ministry of Civil Affairs of Bosnia and Herzegovina

Name of contact person: Biljana Čamur Veselinović

Email and telephone number of contact person: Biljana.camur@mcp.gov.ba +387 33 492 533

I. Ratification and applicability of the Convention against Discrimination in Education¹⁰

- Is your country a State Party to the Convention?

☒ **Yes**

☐ No: Does your country plan to ratify this instrument?

☐ Yes: Please indicate the stage of ratification process reached by your country and whether assistance is needed:

☐ There is interest but no concrete action has been taken

☐ The ratification process has been initiated

☐ The ratification process is close to completion

- Please briefly explain the steps that have been taken and timeline when relevant, any difficulties encountered (legal, institutional, political or practical) in completing the ratification process. And how UNESCO can assist:

☐ No, not considering ratification. Please explain why:

- Is the Convention directly applicable in your country's domestic law?

☒ Yes ☐ No

- Have courts, tribunals and/or administrative authorities adjudicated on issues or violations regarding the right to education?¹¹

☐ No

¹⁰

<https://www.unesco.org/en/legal-affairs/convention-against-discrimination-education>

¹¹

Judicial mechanisms play an important role in enforcing the right to education by ensuring legal accountability and therefore contributing to the practical realization of the right to education.

☐ Yes: Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked?

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please cite the case law and jurisprudence.

Information could also be given about the judicial, administrative and other competent authorities having jurisdiction with respect to the right to education.

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II. Information on the implementation of the Convention or Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4)

1. Towards an inclusive non-discriminatory education system

For reference: This section relates to the main purpose of the Convention/Recommendation that is to underscore the state obligation to proscribe any form of discrimination in education while promoting equality of educational opportunity as laid out in Articles/Paragraphs 1(1), 2 and 3 of the Convention/Recommendation.

It further corresponds to the overall aspiration of SDG4 which aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all” by 2030. While it covers all the SDG4 targets, it also specifically covers SDG target 4.5.¹²

- Please indicate whether the rights and principles laid out in the Convention/Recommendation informed the elaboration of the education legal and/or policy framework:

☒ Yes ☐ No

- If yes, please provide reference:

N.B In Bosnia and Herzegovina Framework laws at all levels of education are at the level of the state of Bosnia and Herzegovina. All laws at the other administrative levels ie. of entity of Republika Srpska, 10 cantons in the entity of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina and at the level of Brcko District in Bosnia and Herzegovina are to be harmonized with it.

Article 3. e) of the **Framework Law on Primary and Secondary Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina** (Official Gazette of Bosnia and Herzegovina No. 18/03) prescribes ensuring of equal opportunities for education and the right to have a choice on all levels of education regardless of gender, race, ethnicity, social and cultural background and status, family status, religion, psycho-social and other personal traits. Article 4 of the Framework Law states that “Every child has equal right to access and the same opportunities of participation in adequate education without discrimination on any basis”.

Article 3 of the **Framework Law on Primary and Secondary Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina** (Official Gazette of Bosnia and Herzegovina, No. 18/3) defines the general goals of education, which include "promotion of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms, and

¹²

Which calls on states to “eliminate gender disparities in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations”.

preparation of each person for life in a society that respects the principles of democracy and the rule of law" (item c) and "ensuring equal opportunities for education and choice at all levels of education, regardless of sex, race, ethnic affiliation, social and cultural background and status, family status, religion, psycho-physical and other personal characteristics" (item e).

The issue of Children's rights to education is regulated by Article 4, paragraph 1 of the Framework Law according to which "Every child shall have equal access and equal opportunities to participate in appropriate education, without discrimination on any ground."

Article 5 (Importance of children's rights) states that "The Rights of the Child pertaining to education, proper care for the benefit of his physical and mental health and safety at schools and in all places where they are educated shall have precedence over all other rights. In case of a conflict of rights, precedence shall be given to such right, interpretation or action that is of the most benefit to the child."

Advancing human rights issue is regulated by Article 6 "The school shall be responsible, both in their own environment and in such environment it affects, to contribute to the creation of a culture that respects human rights and fundamental freedoms of all citizens, as enshrined in the Constitution and other international documents on human rights signed by Bosnia and Herzegovina"; Article 8 provides that "Language and culture of any significant minority in Bosnia and Herzegovina shall be respected and studied at the school to the fullest extent practicable, in accordance with the Framework Convention for the Protection of National Minorities"; Article 9, paragraph 1, states that "The school shall promote and protect religious freedom, tolerance and dialogue", and Article 10, paragraph 1, states that "During teaching and other activities at schools, no didactic or other materials may be used or presented, nor may statements be given by teachers or other school staff, that could be, on a justified basis, considered insulting for the language, culture or religion of pupils belonging to any national, ethnic group or religion."

The Framework Law on Higher Education in BiH (Official Gazette of Bosnia and Herzegovina, No. 59/07, Article 4, paragraph 2, item 5, provides that higher education is based on "respect for human rights and civic freedoms, including ban of all forms of discrimination." Access to higher education is defined in Article 7, paragraph 2, "Higher education within the scope of which the licensed higher education institutions operate in Bosnia and Herzegovina shall not be restricted, either directly or indirectly, based on any realistic or assumed basis such as: sex, race, sexual orientation, physical or other disability, marital status, colour of skin, language, religion, political or other opinion, national, ethnic or social origin, affiliation with an ethnic community, property, birth, age or any other status." Article 38, subparagraph 3 defines the Rights and Obligations of Students "The statute or another equivalent core document of any higher education institution shall contain the provisions that protect students against discrimination on any basis, such as: sex, race, sexual orientation, physical or other disability, marital status, colour of skin, language, religion, political or other opinion, national, ethnic or social origin, affiliation with an ethnic community, property, birth, age or any other status."

It should be emphasized that the ministries of education in the entity Republika Srpska, ten cantons in the Federation of BiH and the Education Department in the Government of the Brcko District of BiH have their own laws at all levels of education, which should be consistent with the framework law at the state level.

1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education

- Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation¹³, and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply):

For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b¹⁴

☐ Legal texts¹⁵ prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education:

- ☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)
- ☒ In primary education
- ☒ In secondary education
- ☒ In technical and vocational education and training
- ☒ In higher education
- ☒ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please indicate the relevant legal provisions:

1. In Framework Law on Preschool Education (Official Gazette of Bosnia and Herzegovina no. 88/07) in article 6 non-discrimination is prescribed. Eight cantonal laws on preschool education in the entity of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina are aligned with this law.
2. The Framework Law on Primary and Secondary Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina ((Official Gazette of Bosnia and Herzegovina no. 18/03), mentioned in the answer to the previous questions, also has articles which define non-discrimination. As already mentioned, all cantonal laws on primary and secondary education in the entity of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina are aligned with the Framework Law on Primary and Secondary Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina.
3. The Framework Law on Vocational Education and Training Education (Official Gazette of Bosnia and Herzegovina no. 63/08) in article 3 mentions that in addition to all general goals defined in the Framework Law on Primary and Secondary Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina (including goals of non-discrimination) some additional goals are prescribed by that law including “ensuring the right to secondary vocational education and training to student under the same conditions, according to his/hers interests and abilities”. Eight cantonal laws on secondary education in the entity of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina are aligned with this law.
4. In article 4, bullet 5, of the Framework Law on Higher Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina Education (Official Gazette of Bosnia and Herzegovina no. 59/07), it is stated that higher education in Bosnia and Herzegovina is based on the respect of human rights and citizen freedoms, including the prohibition of all forms of discrimination. All cantonal laws on higher education in the entity of Federation of

¹³ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

¹⁴ Which calls on states to “substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes”.

¹⁵ Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc.

Bosnia and Herzegovina are aligned with the Framework Law on Higher Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina.

6. Principles and Standards in the field of Adult Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina (Official Gazette of Bosnia and Herzegovina no. 39/14) under the section 2. International and European Standards in the field of Adult Education mentions, among other values, that everyone has the right to education. In addition, it is mentioned that principles and standards defined in this document are based on the international and European standards and principles of adult education. All cantonal laws on adult education in the entity of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina are aligned with Principles and Standards in the field of Adult Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina.

In entity of Republika Srpska, 10 cantons in entity of the Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina and Brcko District, equal and non-discriminatory access to all levels of education is ensured in accordance with the provisions of the framework laws for all levels of education in Bosnia and Herzegovina. All laws at all administrative levels in Bosnia and Herzegovina are harmonized with framework laws at the level of the state of Bosnia and Herzegovina.

- Please list the prohibited grounds of discrimination in education as laid out in legal texts:

Gender, race, ethnicity, social and cultural background and status, family status, religion, psycho-social and other personal traits.

CHAPTER I. PRINCIPLES AND GOALS OF PRESCHOOL UPBRINGING AND EDUCATION
Section A. Basic Principles and Goals - Framework Law on Preschool Education (Official Gazette of Bosnia and Herzegovina no. 88/07)

Article 4 (Development Principles)

The preschool upbringing and education in Bosnia and Herzegovina are characterized by the following development principles:

- a) humanistic development principle,
- b) principle of professional autonomy and expert responsibility, and
- c) principle of democracy.

Article 5 (Recognition of the Degree of Child's Development)

The preschool upbringing and education based on the humanistic principle of upbringing and education, through modern scientific accomplishments and theories on child's development and rights of the child, shall on a mandatory basis recognize the degree of child's development, specific qualities of development possibilities and individual needs of the child.

Article 6 (Ban of Discrimination)

(1) Every child shall have an equal right to access to and an equal opportunity for participation in appropriate upbringing and education without discrimination on any basis.

(2) Equal access and equal opportunities understand ensuring of equal conditions and opportunities for all, for beginning and continuation of further upbringing and education.

Section B. Principles and Goals Ensuring the Basic Rights of Children

Article 7 (Ensuring of the Best Interest of the Child)

- (1) The right of the child to upbringing and education and proper care for the benefit of their physical and mental health and safety shall supersede all other rights.
- (2) In case of conflict of rights, such right, interpretation or action shall prevail that shall be of the best interest for the child.

Article 8 (Ensuring of Proper Values)

The general goals in upbringing and education arise from the generally accepted universal values of the democratic society, and from proper value systems based on the specific qualities of the ethnic, historical, cultural and religious tradition of the peoples and ethnic minorities living in Bosnia and Herzegovina.

Article 9 (Ensuring of Optimum Development of the Child)

The general goal of the preschool upbringing and education is to ensure optimum and equal conditions in order to have every child, from the birth to the school age, develop and accomplish their full potentials and skills, through various forms of quality and professional autonomous institutional and non-institutional preschool upbringing and education.

Article 10 (The Right to Language)

The languages and cultures of all constitutive peoples and each ethnic minority living in Bosnia and Herzegovina shall be respected and integrated into the preschool institutions in accordance with the Constitution of Bosnia and Herzegovina, the European Convention on Protection of Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms, the Framework Convention for Protection of Ethnic Minorities, and the Convention on the Rights of the Child.

Article 11 (Respect for Religious Freedoms)

Preschool institutions shall develop, promote and respect ethnic and religious freedoms, customs, tolerance and the culture of dialogue, pursuant to Article 10, of this Law.

Also, for example Law on Higher Education of Republika Srpska: Article 8 – The Right to Higher Education: “Access to higher education can not be limited directly or indirectly on the basis of: gender, gender identity, race, sexual orientation, physical or other disability, marital status, colour, skin, language, religion, political or other opinion, national, ethnic or social origin, connection with a national community, property, number of years or some other status”.

✓ Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education

- ☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)
- ☒ In primary education
- ☒ In secondary education
- ☐ In technical and vocational education and training
- ☒ In higher education
- ☐ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please provide details:

The joint European Union and Council of Europe programme “Horizontal Facility for the Western Balkans and Turkey” (Horizontal Facility III) is a co-operation initiative,

running from 2023 until 2026. The programme covers actions in Albania, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Kosovo*, Montenegro, North Macedonia, Serbia and Turkey. It enables the Beneficiaries to meet their reform agendas in the fields of human rights, rule of law and democracy and to comply with European standards, which is also a priority for the EU enlargement process. The Horizontal Facility builds upon the results and progress achieved by the programme, since 2016 which, among others, includes better legislation, policies and capacities on inclusiveness and integrity in education, anti-discrimination, protection of minorities, women's access to justice and the fight against trafficking in human beings.

<https://rm.coe.int/hfiii-leaflet-web-eng/1680ab5922>

The action "Quality education for all – Bosnia and Herzegovina" proposes a series of complementary measures at policy, grass roots and regional levels to further improve the quality of education in Bosnia and Herzegovina by fostering a culture of democracy and inclusion and combatting all forms of discrimination in the formal education system, in line with the Council of Europe standards and tools and developed in consultation with key stakeholders and final beneficiaries.

[Quality education for all - Bosnia and Herzegovina - Council of Europe Office in Sarajevo \(coe.int\)](#)

In all defined standards of students' achievements in all fields this approach was integrated.

Preschool Upbringing and Education

Quality standards of the work of preschool institutions:

<https://aposo.gov.ba/sadrzaj/uploads/Standardi-kvaliteta-rada-predskolskih-ustanova-BOS-1.pdf>

[Standards of learning and development of a child at preschool age:](#)

<https://aposo.gov.ba/bs/standardi-ucenja-i-razvoja-djeteta-u-dobi-pred-polazak-u-osnovnu-skolu/>

Common core of comprehensive developmental programs for preschool upbringing and education defined by learning outcomes

<https://aposo.gov.ba/sadrzaj/uploads/ZJCRP-predskolski-odgoj-i-obrazovanje-B.pdf>

Guidelines for the implementation of the Common core of comprehensive developmental programs for preschool upbringing and education defined on learning outcomes

<https://aposo.gov.ba/sadrzaj/uploads/Smjernice-ZJCRP.pdf>

Guidelines for inclusive upbringing and education

<https://aposo.gov.ba/sadrzaj/uploads/Smjernice.pdf>

Also, Development Strategy for Science and Technology, Higher Education and Information Society in entity of Republika Srpska

☐ Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum:

☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)

☒ In primary education

☒ In secondary education

☐ In technical and vocational education and training

- ☒ In higher education
- ☐ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please provide details:

Moreover, this approach is defined in all the fields and regions of the common core curriculum.

- ☐ Other measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education:

The Agency for Preschool, Primary and Secondary Education offered the tool for evaluation of work quality of primary schools, as well as tools for intercultural learning and the Code of Ethics which contains proposals for eliminating discrimination in education, but also establishes equity and equality in education.

Moreover, statutes of the higher education institutions in Bosnia and Herzegovina also contain provisions that protect the staff and students of the higher education institutions from discrimination on any basis, such as: gender, race, sexual orientation, gender identity, marital status, skin colour, language, religion, political or other opinion, national, ethnic or social, association with a national community, property, birth or any other status.

1.2 Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education

- Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (*several items may be ticked*):

General measures:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☒ Legislation provides for inclusive education for all | ☐ Multiple and flexible learning pathways ¹⁷ are provided for |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance inclusion in education for all | ☒ Curricula and teaching methods are inclusive in design ¹⁸ |
| ☒ Teachers are trained on inclusive education ¹⁶ and to value diversity | ☒ Multilingual and intercultural education is supported |

¹⁶ Teachers are prepared to teach all student (beyond just students with disabilities), equipping them with knowledge, values and attitudes that permit every student to succeed. See: [UNESCO policy paper](#): Inclusive teaching: preparing all teachers to teach all students, 2020, p.14.

¹⁷ Multiple and flexible learning pathways are 'entry points and re-entry points at all ages and all educational levels, strengthened links between formal and non-formal structures, and recognition, validation and accreditation of the knowledge, skills and competencies acquired through nonformal and informal education' ([Education 2030 Framework for Action](#), para. 33). This may include student transfers between courses and institutions and diverse learning modalities (online, in-person, full-time, part-time, etc.) to respond to individual needs and interests.

¹⁸ In designing the curricula and teaching methods, care is given to ensure that all students are provided with an inclusive and supportive learning experience that offers them the opportunity to succeed whatever their background.

- ☐ Initiatives to address discrimination and promote cultural diversity and mutual acceptance

✓ Other:

Ministry of Education and Science of the entity of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina implements several programs aiming to enhance inclusion of all at all levels and types of education. Examples of programs that are being implemented are: 1) the Support to Projects of Improving the Inclusiveness of Preschool, Primary and Secondary Education; 2) the Support to Excellent Roma Pupils in Primary and Secondary Education in entity of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina; 3) the Support to Roma Students (B&H citizens with residence in entity of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina) Studying at the Higher Education Institutions in entity of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina; 4) the Support to Students with Disabilities (B&H citizens with residence in entity of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina) Studying at the Higher Education Institutions in the entity of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

The policy document "Policy Recommendations with a Roadmap for Improving Inclusive Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina" was adopted in 2020 by Council of Ministers of Bosnia and Herzegovina. (Original title of the document: Preporuke za politike djelovanja s Mapom puta za unapređenje inkluzivnog obrazovanja u Bosni i Hercegovini).

Authorities in Bosnia and Herzegovina (BiH) continue to support the implementation of the Policy Recommendations with a Roadmap for Improving Inclusive Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina developed jointly by relevant ministries at state level, entity ministries of education and 10 cantonal ministries of education in April 2019 under the joint European Union/Council of Europe action "Quality education in multi-ethnic societies" and adopted by the Council of Ministers in September 2020.

The Policy Recommendations with a Roadmap aim to improve quality of education for all in Bosnia and Herzegovina, in line with European standards and according to the vision for quality education reflected in the Council of Europe's Committee of Ministers recommendations. The Roadmap foresees Bosnia and Herzegovina's diverse society to be further integrated and enhanced by increasing social cohesion based on the intercultural competences of students, their parents and teachers.

The joint European Union/Council of Europe action "Quality Education for all" is supporting effective implementation of the Roadmap including capacity building for different target groups (teachers, members of school management, pedagogical institutions) and providing tools, instruments and practical examples related to the Reference Framework of Competences for Democratic Culture (RFCDC).

The progress on the implementation of the Roadmap was discussed during the session of the Council of Ministers of BiH on 20 December 2023. This discussion was based on a report

prepared by the Ministry of Civil Affairs of Bosnia and Herzegovina, in cooperation with the competent educational authorities in BiH and other key actors.

The Council of Ministers urges competent education authorities to provide the necessary conditions and resources required for the third phase of the joint action of the European Union and the Council of Europe entitled "Quality Education for All". Furthermore, they encourage enabling the incorporation of the Reference Framework of Competences for Democratic Culture in the education systems in BiH. This commitment confirms the dedication to the effective implementation of the Policy Recommendations with a Roadmap for Improving Inclusive Education, including its objective of developing an education vision and mission in BiH.

The action "Quality education for all" is part of the joint European Union and Council of Europe programme "Horizontal Facility for the Western Balkans and Türkiye".

[Bosnia and Herzegovina's Council of Ministers ensures its commitment to quality education for all - Council of Europe Office in Sarajevo \(coe.int\)](#)

Also In the entity of Republika Srpska, equal and non-discriminatory access to higher education is ensured in accordance with the provision of the Law on Higher Education of Republika Srpska: Articlele 8, paragraph 2. – The right to Higher Education: "Access to higher Education cannot be limited directly or indirectly on the basis of: gender, gender identity, race, sexual orientation, physical or other disability, marital status, color skin, language, religion, political or other opinion, national , ethnic or social origin, connection with a national community, property, number of years or some other status".

- In general, what challenges were encountered in the implementation of non-discrimination and equal opportunities principles in education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☒ Legislation provides for gender equality in education | ☒ All barriers for pregnant girls and young mothers in education are eliminated to ensure the continuity of their education |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance gender equality | ☐ Re-entry programmes for young mothers are provided for |
| ☐ Gender-responsive education sector planning is undertaken | ☐ Ensuring safe and adequate gender-sensitive sanitation facilities ²⁰ |

²⁰ ' Gender-sensitive sanitation includes clean, safe and separate toilets, with access to water and garbage disposal' ([UNGEI blog post](#), Gender-sensitive sanitation, 2018)

- ☐ Providing positive or affirmative action measures
- ☐ Providing financial incentives and fellowships
- ☐ Teachers are trained (initial and in-service) on gender equality
- ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation¹⁹
- ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes²¹ and bias
- ✓ Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM)
- ✓ Ensuring gender parity in technical and vocational training education and training (TVET)

✓Other:

Ministry of Education and Science of entity of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina implements the programme aiming to support the projects of training and professional training of adults, focusing on women, with the purpose of easier integration into the labour market.

In entity of Republika Srpska, equal and non-discriminatory access to higher education is ensured in accordance with the provisions of the Law on Higher Education of the Republika Srpska entity:

Article 8, paragraph 5.- The Rights to Higher Education: "Grammatical expressions used in this law to indicate the masculine and feminine genders imply both genders"

Article 4, item 18. – Principles of higher education: "Grammatical expressions used in this law to indicate the masculine and feminine genders imply both genders". Article 72, paragraph 1, item 3,4 – Suspensions of rights and obligations of students prescribes that at the student's request, suspension of rights and obligations is granted in case of maintenance of pregnancy and care of the child up to one year of age.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in achieving gender equality in and through education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

- Does the legal minimum age for marriage conform to international standards (18 years) ²²:

¹⁹ ' Stigmatisation is the act of treating someone or something unfairly by publicly disapproving of them' (Cambridge Dictionary).

²¹ Stereotype is a set idea that people have about what someone or something is like, especially an idea that is wrong' (Cambridge Dictionary).

²² Please note that according to the Joint general recommendation No. 31 of the Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women/general comment No. 18 of the Committee on the Rights of the Child on harmful practice, para. 20: "a marriage of a mature, capable child below 18 years of age may be allowed in exceptional circumstances, provided that the child is at least 16 years of age and that such decisions are made by a judge based on legitimate exceptional grounds defined by law and on the evidence of maturity, without deference to culture and tradition."

Please note that child marriage is a discriminatory practice as often girls can marry at a younger age than boys. Child marriage violates the child's right to education as they are more likely to drop out of school and children who are not in school are more likely to get married.

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate the exceptions to the legal age of marriage as well as the absolute minimum age:

Article 35 of the Family Law of entity of Republika Srpska (Official Gazette of Republika Srpska", no. 54/2002, 41/2008 i 63/2014) prescribes:

“(1) Marriage cannot be concluded by a person who has not reached the age of 18.

(2) For justified reasons, the court may, in non-litigation proceedings, allow the marriage of a minor over the age of 16, if it is established that this person is physically and mentally capable of exercising the rights and duties arising from marriage.

(3) A proposal for a marriage license from paragraph 2 of this article may be submitted to the court by an interested minor.

(4) Before making a decision, the court obtains the opinion of the competent guardianship authority”.

Family Law of entity of the Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina (Official gazette of Federation of BiH», no 31/14 od 23.04.2014) stipulates:

Article 15.

(1) Marriage cannot be concluded by a person who has not reached the age of 18.

(2) Exceptionally, the court may, in a non-litigation procedure, allow marriage to a person who has reached 16 years of age if it determines that there are justified reasons that this person is physically and mentally capable of exercising the rights and duties arising from marriage and that marriage is in her/his interest.

Article 16

(1) The marriage is not valid if the spouse consented to its conclusion in fear by a serious threat or in a delusion about the personality of the other spouse or about his essential traits.

(2) A delusion about the personality of the spouse exists when the spouse thought he was entering into a marriage with one person, and he made it with another person.

(3) A delusion about an essential characteristic of a spouse exists when it is a characteristic or circumstance which would have deterred the other spouse from entering into marriage if he knew about her, especially in the case extremely dangerous or serious diseases, permanent and incurable sexual impotence, pregnancy of a woman with another man and previous convictions for a criminal offense committed against the dignity of a person and morals.

Family Law of Brcko District of Bosnia and Herzegovina stipulates (adopted at session of the Government of Brcko District on June 17, 2007):

Article 26

(Majority as a condition for concluding marriage)

(1) Marriage cannot be concluded by a person who has not reached the age of 18.

(2) For justified reasons, the court may allow in non-litigation proceedings

marriage to a minor over 16 years old.

C) Prohibitions for marriage

Article 27

(Marriage of adoptee and adopter)

(1) Marriage cannot be concluded by the adopted person and the adoptive parent during the duration of the incomplete marriage

of adoption.

(2) For justified reasons, the court may, in non-litigation proceedings, to persons from

of the previous paragraph, upon their request, allow the conclusion of the marriage.

(3) A marriage concluded in accordance with the provisions of paragraph 2 of this article cannot be annulled.

National minorities:

For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities.

- | | |
|---|--|
| ✓ Legislation provides for the right to education of national minorities | ☐ Teachers are trained on intercultural education |
| ✓ Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of national minorities | ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ²⁴ |
| ☐ Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities | o Multilingual and intercultural education are supported |
| | o Native language instruction is ensured for national minorities |

- ☐ The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for national minorities
- ☐ Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by national minorities
- ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for national minorities
- ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for national minorities
- ☐ Other²³:
 - ☐ Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for national minorities
 - ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes²⁵ and bias

The framework legislation in the field of education in BiH and the Law on the Protection of National Minorities in BiH (Official Gazette of BiH, No. 12/03 and 76/05) established the rights and obligations of members of national minorities in BiH and obligations of the authorities in Bosnia and Herzegovina to respect, protect, preserve and develop ethnic, cultural, linguistic and religious identity of each member of a national minority in Bosnia and Herzegovina who is a citizen of Bosnia and Herzegovina. The Law on the Protection of National Minorities, Article 2, specifies that the protection of the rights and freedoms of these minorities is an integral part of the international protection of human rights and freedoms. The Framework Convention for the Protection of National Minorities of the Council of Europe is directly applicable and is an integral part of the legal system of BiH and the BiH entities. According to Article 21 of the state Law on the Protection of National Minorities, the Parliamentary Assembly of BiH established the Council of National Minorities as a special advisory body composed of the members of national minorities.

17 national minorities are registered in Bosnia and Herzegovina, while the Roma population is the largest.

In article 3. of the Framework Law on Primary and Secondary Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina (Official Gazette of Bosnia and Herzegovina no. 18/03) it is defined that general objectives of education stem from generally accepted, universal values of democratic society, and one's own value systems based on the specifics of national, historical, cultural and religious traditions of peoples and **national minorities** living in Bosnia and Herzegovina.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

For example Article 10 of the Law on Protection of the Rights of Members of National Minorities of the entity of Republika Srpska prescribes:

"1. Members of national minorities can establish and run their own private institutions for education and professional training.

2. Financing of the institutions referred to in paragraph 1 of this article shall be provided by members of national minorities."

²³ Please see: [UNESCO report](#) 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023.

²⁵ Supra note 16.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of minorities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

The main issue to be solved in order to promote equal educational opportunities is to provide the financial resources to exercise the rights guaranteed by law in practice, and ensure the social conditions for inclusion of children from marginalized social groups and positive action when it comes to these groups (children, members of national minorities – especially Roma, children with disabilities, children from socially and economically disadvantaged families, children from traffic-separated areas, etc). Educational inclusion cannot be successfully implemented if it is not part of the overall social inclusion.

Work on the improvement of education conditions, equal access and nondiscrimination is a constant, continued and unpredictable process that needs more investments through the education of parents, students and entire school staff, a change of consciousness in society about the others, various events, the organization of panel discussions, workshops, seminars and conferences at local and state levels, and promotion through the media.

Indigenous people:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Legislation provides for the right to education of indigenous people | ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for indigenous people |
| ☐ Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of indigenous people | ☐ Teachers are trained on intercultural education |
| ☐ Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities | ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ²⁶ |
| ☐ The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for indigenous people | ☐ Multilingual and intercultural education are supported |
| ☐ Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by indigenous people | ☐ Native language instruction is ensured |
| ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for indigenous people | ☐ Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for indigenous people |
| ☐ Other: | ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²⁷ and bias |

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

²⁶ Supra note 15.

²⁷ Supra note 16.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of indigenous people? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations²⁸:

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☒ Legislation provides for their right to education | ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education | ☐ Auxiliary assistance is provided |
| ☐ Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured | ☐ Multiple and flexible learning pathways ³¹ are provided |
| ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for | ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ³² and bias |
| ☐ All administrative barriers to access education are removed | ☐ Accelerated learning programmes are provided |
| ☐ Alternative administrative procedures (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.) to overcome administrative barriers ²⁹ are provided for | ☐ Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes are provided |
| ☐ Teachers are specifically trained to ensure their inclusion | ☐ Language classes to newcomers are provided for |
| ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ³⁰ | ☐ Multilingualism and intercultural education are encouraged |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- Have specific measures been adopted for climate displaced persons?

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please elaborate:

²⁸ 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' ([UNESCO report](#): The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2).

²⁹ While lack of documentation (such as identity papers, birth certificates, residency permits, etc.) should not be an obstacle to access education, these can constitute a barrier to education See: [UNESCO publication](#): Handbook on the right to education, 2018, p. 96.

³⁰ Supra note 15.

³¹ Supra note 13

³² Supra note 16.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of migrants, refugees, asylum seekers, stateless persons and IDPs? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

People with disabilities:

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☒ Legislation provides for their right to education | ☐ Mainstream teachers are specifically trained on disabilities |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education | ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ³³ |
| ☐ Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured | ☐ Auxiliary assistance is provided |
| ☐ Special schools are used as resource centers to inclusive schools | ☐ Curricula and teaching and learning methods are adapted |
| ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided | ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ³⁴ and bias |
| ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided | ☒ Education infrastructure and learning materials are adapted |
| ☐ Other | |

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

In article 19. paragraf 1 of the Framework Law on Primary and Secondary Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina (Official Gazette of Bosnia and Herzegovina no. 18/03) it is stated that children and youth with special educational needs acquire education in regular schools and according to the programmes adapted to their individual needs. The individual programme, adapted to their abilities and capacities, will be developed for each student/pupil, with the compulsory determination of special need status".

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of people with disabilities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Students from poor households:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☒ Financial incentives and fellowships for school enrolment are provided | ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ³⁵ |
|--|--|

³³ Supra note 15.

³⁴ Supra note 16.

³⁵ Supra note 15.

✓ Transport, meals and education material are subsidised or provided free of charge beyond compulsory education

☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes³⁶ and bias

☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided

☐ Other:

For example, in entity of Republika Srpska, the Law on Student Standards is in force. By this Law, the right to accommodation, food and transport for students from poor household, is regulated. They have a right to apply for accommodation and food free of charge also as for the scholarships.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of students from poor households? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

2. Progress made with respect to implementing the right to education across all levels and forms of education

2.1 Early childhood care and education

For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation³⁷ and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education³⁸. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (*several items may be ticked*):

☐ Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are free

☐ Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are affordable

☐ ECCE services are accessible on a non-discriminatory basis

✓ ECCE services respect a child’s need for early cognitive and social development, foundational learning, responsive care, nutrition, health, safety, protection, and play.

³⁶ Supra note 16.

³⁷ Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”.

³⁸ Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE”

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

- Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available?

☒ Pre-primary education is compulsory. Please provide the age of enrolment and duration:

Framework Law on Preschool Upbringing and Education in Bosnia and Herzegovina (Official Gazette of Bosnia and Herzegovina no. 88/07)

☒ Article 16 (Age of mandatory inclusion of children into preschool education)

☒ (1) In the year before enrollment into primary school, preschool upbringing and education shall be mandatory for all children of preschool age.

☒ (2) The terms and conditions for financing, the programs and duration of preschool upbringing and education shall be regulated by the competent education authorities in an appropriate law.

In eight cantonal laws on preschool education in Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina it is defined that pre-primary education programmes of certain duration are compulsory. Seven cantons implement these laws which prescribe compulsory preschool program in year prior to primary school and cantonal ministries of education finance these compulsory programs, where they are implemented.

☐ Pre-primary education is **not** compulsory.

☐ Pre-primary education is free of charge for all. Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is free:

☐ Pre-primary education is **not** free.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

Parents pay for their children to stay in preschool institutions for all ages, from 6 months until they leave for school. An exception is a free program of the compulsory preschool program for children in the year before starting primary school, who are not covered by other preschool programs (do not attend kindergartens).

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education?

✓ Limited access

✓ Issues of equity and inclusion

☐ Poor quality programmes

☐ Other:

☐ Poor learning outcomes

☐ Low number of professionally trained educators

✓ Lack of support to families

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

In order to improve the quality of Comprehensive developmental programs, Agency for Preschool, Primary and Secondary Education (APOS) developed the Common core of comprehensive developmental programs for preschool education defined on learning outcomes (2018) and Guidelines for the implementation of the Common core of comprehensive developmental programs for preschool education defined on learning outcomes (2021). On the basis of these documents, which serve as a framework for the ministries of education and pedagogical institutes, they further develop Comprehensive developmental programs.

Bosnia and Herzegovina have the lowest rate of inclusion of children in organized preschool upbringing and education in Europe.

2.2 Primary and secondary education

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for universal primary and secondary education. In the context of the Education 2030 agenda, SDG target 4.1 calls on States to provide “12 years of free, publicly funded, inclusive, equitable, quality primary and secondary education – of which at least nine years are compulsory.”

Primary education

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of primary education:

Children are enrolled at the earliest at the age of 5.5 years, and the duration of primary education is nine years.

- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge?

✓ Primary education is compulsory

☐ Primary education is **not** compulsory.

✓ Primary education is free of charge.

☐ Primary education is **not** free.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education?

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Limited access
✓ Issues of equity and inclusion
☐ High dropout rates
✓ Poor quality programmes
☐ Other: | ✓ Poor learning outcomes in:
Foundation literacy
Numeracy
✓ Social and emotional learning
Others
✓ Disparity in learning outcomes
☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers |
|--|--|

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Agency for Preschool, Primary and Secondary Education created a Common core defined by learning outcomes in 2018 on the basis of which ministries of education and pedagogical institutes develop new subject curricula from 2020. The process is still ongoing. The Common core has provided learning outcomes for all relevant participants who take them on and further develop them.

Agency for Preschool, Primary and Secondary Education developed in 2020 the Guidelines for inclusive upbringing and education which provide an overview of the legal and regulatory acts relevant to inclusive upbringing and education, as well as guidelines for further development of inclusive upbringing and education. The guidelines are divided into two levels: legal and regulatory regulations and practices. They represent a framework for harmonizing the understanding of inclusive upbringing and education in the whole territory of Bosnia and Herzegovina, improving legal regulations related to the understanding of inclusive upbringing and education, ensuring the realization of the right to quality education and upbringing for every child, the basis for the development of educational programs and guiding educational authorities to fulfil the tasks to which they have committed themselves by signing international documents.

The document serves, on the one hand, to better understand inclusion as one of the fundamental values in upbringing and education that has its starting point the respect for diversity, and which focuses on the potential, abilities, needs and interests of each child/student. On the other hand, the document aims to clearly outline the next steps important for the development of inclusive upbringing and education. All the guidelines and activities set out in the document are based on the qualitative collection of data through the analysis of documentation – legal and regulative acts, and through information by decision makers and practitioners collected through focus group interviews.

The guidelines emphasize the importance of the coordinated action of all relevant actors in order to make a synergistic use of resources, all in the interest of equal, accessible and quality upbringing and education for every child/student.

Agency for Preschool, Primary and Secondary Education also developed in 2022 the Competence standard for external evaluators which, through the areas of expertise, knowledge, skills, attitudes and characteristics of the competent evaluators, defines what is needed for the team members in the process of evaluation. This document includes the areas relating to environmental sustainability, social inclusion, gender equality, context of the work of educational institutions. With this document, Agency for Preschool, Primary and Secondary Education made also its contribution in the area of improving and cherishing a culture of quality in the area of non-discrimination.

During the development of standards of occupation and qualification, Agency for Preschool, Primary and Secondary Education takes charge that, while defining and formulating the expressions for learning outcomes, the non-discrimination norms on any basis (racial, social, gender, religion, etc.) are met.

Secondary education

In this part, please provide information on the general availability and accessibility to all of secondary education, including technical and vocational secondary education and training.

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of lower secondary education:

In the formal secondary vocational education programs, students are enrolled after completing primary education (14/15 years old). *Duration of the secondary education is 3-4 years, depending on the programme (some vocational education programs last for three years, other programs (exp. general and technical) last for four years.*

The principles of organization of secondary vocational education and training are determined by the Framework Law on Secondary Vocational Education and Training in Bosnia and Herzegovina (Official Gazette of Bosnia and Herzegovina no. 63/08).

The Article 6 of this law defines the duration of education:

1. Secondary technical, art and special-purpose schools which fulfil the conditions determined by the classification of occupations as a rule are implementing a four-year curriculum for obtaining a professional title which enables continuation of education in higher education institutions.
2. Vocational-craft schools as a rule have a three-year curriculum for obtaining appropriate professional title.
3. According to the labor market requirements, the competent authorities may determine education and training less than three years for performing less complex and simple jobs, as a form of obtaining qualification according to the related profession.

According to the Baseline Qualification Framework in Bosnia and Herzegovina, these are the levels 2, 3 and 4 in accordance with EQF (the programs of vocational training, secondary vocational education and training and secondary technical education).

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of upper secondary education:

Children enter secondary education when they are 15 years old, and the duration of the secondary education is 3-4 years, depending on the programme (some vocational education programs last for three years, other programs (exp. general and technical) last for four years).

- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge?

- ☐ Lower secondary education is compulsory.
- ☐ Lower secondary education is **not** compulsory.

- ☐ Lower secondary education is free of charge.
- ☐ Lower secondary education is **not** free of charge.
- ☐ Upper secondary education is compulsory.
- ☐ Upper secondary education is **not** compulsory.
- ☐ Upper secondary education is free of charge
- ☐ Upper secondary education is **not** free of charge.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

Regular secondary education, including technical and vocational education, is completely free and funded from the budget of the relevant education authorities and is available to everyone under equal conditions. The legislative framework promotes and provides education for all high school students under the same conditions with the use of high standards of education and application of optimal conditions for the development of the personality of the child, appropriate to his age, abilities, social and physical skills. Students do not pay high school enrolment and attendance fee, but there is no legal obligation to pay for textbooks and transportation, although some local communities and competent ministries of education in BiH co-finance transport of high school students.

- Please indicate whether the legal minimum age for employment is aligned with the end of compulsory education:

For reference: The employment laws and those related to compulsory education are interdependent and mutually reinforce each other. If the minimum age of employment is below that of compulsory education, the child is at risk of dropping out of school to work and therefore not completing compulsory education. On the other hand, if compulsory education is lower than the minimum age of employment, once the child has completed compulsory education, the door is open to child exploitation and the violation of labour laws.

Yes ✓ No

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate how the provision is enforced:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education?

- ☐ Limited access
- ☐ Poor learning outcomes

- ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion
- ☐ High dropout rates
- ☐ Poor quality programmes
- ☐ Other:
- ☐ Low readiness of primary graduates
- ☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

2.3 Higher education

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3³⁹, and target 4.4⁴⁰. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training.

- Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (*several items may be ticked*):

- ☒ Higher education is free of charge
- ☒ Higher education is accessible on the basis of individual capacity (as assessed by reference to relevant qualifications and experience)
- ☒ Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships
- ☐ Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures
- ☐ Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states
- ☐ Higher education allows for multiple and flexible learning pathways (flexible entry and re-entry, recognition, validation, and accreditation of knowledge and skills acquired through non-formal and informal education).
- ☐ Other:

³⁹ Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”.

⁴⁰ Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, university supplies, transport, accommodation). Brief quantitative information may be added.

The Framework Law on Higher Education in BiH (Official Gazette of BiH, No. 59/07), Article 7, specifies that the **access to higher education** is available to all those who have completed four-years high school in Bosnia and Herzegovina. The access to higher education, based on individual capacity, guarantees a legal framework which provides for equality in the sense that higher education is an activity directed toward the full development of human personality, respect for human rights, civil and other democratic, academic, legal and constitutional principles and freedoms. According to the Law, the access to higher education may not be restricted, directly or indirectly, on any ground actual or presumed contrary to the Constitution, legislation and international legislation, such as gender, race, sexual orientation, physical or other disability, marital status, colour, language, religion, political or other opinion, national, ethnic or social origin, affiliation with a national community, property, birth or some other status.

The students who have completed secondary school abroad submit proof of completion of secondary school, certificate or diploma, for evaluation to the competent institution that takes into account the criteria and procedures for the recognition of foreign qualifications established in accordance with the principles of the Convention on the Recognition of Qualifications concerning Higher Education in the European Region, as defined in the Framework Law on Higher Education in BiH, Article 8.

Based on criteria defined in the rulebooks, most successful students are given scholarships (through public competition), accommodation in student centers is co-funded for full-time students, and other incentives of a financial nature are also provided in order to facilitate the general living conditions of families, students (one-time assistance), and co-financing of MA theses and PhD dissertations.

Also, in accordance with the Law on Higher Education of entity of Republika Srpska, the higher education is free of charge. Only students that repeat the year of studies or do not enroll into the approved quotas (from Government).

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education?

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Limited access | ☐ Low number of professionally trained professors |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☐ Insufficient mechanisms to ensure smooth transition from secondary to tertiary |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | |
| ☒ Poor learning outcomes | |

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.”

- Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (*several items may be ticked*):

☒ Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education

☐ Provision of literacy programmes

☒ Provision of continuous learning (such as learning programmes to develop knowledge, skills, abilities, or competencies for personal and professional development)

☐ Provision of free of charge learning opportunities

☒ Provision of professional training including reskilling and upskilling programmes

☐ Recognition, validation and certification of non-formal and informal learning

☐ Provision of free of charge career guidance and counselling

☐ Lifelong learning entitlements including learning accounts, vouchers, etc.

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Limited access | ☐ Limited funding |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☐ Poor learning outcomes |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | ☐ Low number of professionally trained educators |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Through the project the European Agenda for Adult Learning, ERASMUS+, Agency for Preschool, Primary and Secondary Education developed a document Improving the skills of adults – a social challenge for Bosnia and Herzegovina which provides the information about the European trends and needs in the area of adult education. This publication represents the progress made in the area of arrangement and improvement of the Adult education system in Bosnia and Herzegovina until 2017. On the way to adopting European principles, one of the tasks is increasing the possibilities for social inclusion of all the members, especially those who have to obtain new skills for specific requirements which modern times require. The projects which in Bosnia and Herzegovina contribute to the accomplishment of this task are represented in one part of the publication.

3. Quality education provision and learning environment

For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2, 4(b) and 5(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for quality education. Quality education is fundamental to achieve all targets of SDG4. It is also particularly highlighted in SDG target 4.a that recommends states to “build and upgrade education facilities that are child, disability and gender sensitive and provide safe, non-violent, inclusive and effective learning environments for all”.

3.1 General measures

- Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding:

- ☒ State monitoring and inspections
- ☒ Health and sanitation
- ☒ Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))
- ☒ Infrastructure
- ☒ Curriculum
- ☒ Student-teacher ratio
- ☐ School fees (if relevant)
- ☐ Other

Considering the first point (state monitoring and inspections, it is important to note that relevant ministries and institutions at the competent level of authority have their inspections. In case of the entity of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina, cantonal

ministries of education have their inspections, and pedagogic institutes have their role in supporting and advising teachers and schools.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

You may include information on policies, protocols or codes of conduct.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Non-supportive or inadequate learning environments | ☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials |
| ☐ Violence in schools | ☐ Inadequate parental support to education |
| ☐ Cost of education | ☐ Long distances to schools |
| ☐ Conflicts or crises | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.2 Education personnel

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked):

- ☒ Teacher training is provided without discrimination.
- ☐ Teachers' average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels).
- ☐ Initial training and continuous professional development are provided.
- ☒ Minimum standards and qualifications required for the teaching profession.
- ☐ Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession.
- ☐ Measures taken to promote diversity in the teaching workforce, including to redress gender imbalances at different levels of education.
- ☐ Establishment of performance monitoring systems.

☐ Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education.

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

All teaching staff have access to training without discrimination on any basis.

Minimum standards and qualifications required for the teaching profession at each level of education is regulated by cantonal laws and bylaws in the entity of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina.

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel?

☐ Shortages of teaching staff

o Low quality educational infrastructure and materials

☐ Lack of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff

o High student – teacher ratio

☐ Lack of training centres

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms

For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.⁴¹ Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1.

- Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked):

✓ Curriculum includes human rights education.

✓ Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education.

⁴¹

Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”.

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

The Common Core Curriculum for Civic Education Defined on the Learning Outcomes (Official Gazette of Bosnia and Herzegovina, no. 3/16) includes human rights education.

Original title of the document: Zajednička jezgra nastavnih planova i programa za građansko obrazovanje definirana na ishodima učenja.

3.4 Non-state actors in education

For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision⁴².

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked):

☐ Legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation⁴³ explicitly apply to non-state educational institutions. Please specify:

☐ Policies aim to guarantee that the development of non-state education does not generate discrimination and that non-state actors offer a relevant alternative (without supplanting public education). Please specify:

☐ Legal provisions provide for the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children. Please specify:

✓ Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered:

- ☒ Registration
- ☒ State monitoring and inspections
- ☒ Qualifications of teachers

⁴² Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors.

⁴³ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

- ☒ Health and sanitation
- ☒ Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))
- ☒ Infrastructure
- ☒ Curriculum
- ☒ Student-teacher ratio
- ☐ School fees
- ☒ School closures
- ☐ Other

- Please elaborate:

The cantons in the entity of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina, entity of Republika Srpska and Brcko District are the responsible level of government for regulations on the standards and other requirements for opening, for working and for closing of the private educational institutions. The ministries of education at all administrative units (10 cantons of the entity of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina, entity of Republika Srpska and Brcko District) in Bosnia and Herzegovina are the competent legal authorities for monitoring the work of private educational institutions.

- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials | ☐ Issues in terms of equity and inclusion |
| ☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers | ☐ Weak government regulatory and monitoring capacity |
| ☐ High student – teacher ratio | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.5 Digital education

Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion⁴⁴.

⁴⁴ Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked):

- ✓ Digital technology use in education is provided for in the legal framework.

Please indicate the relevant text and provisions:

- ✓ Core legislations, policies, strategies or plans for the management, privacy, security, storage, transfer, use, and sharing of education data internally and externally to ensure the right to privacy of learners and education stakeholders (e.g., informed consent, transparent usage policies, etc.)

- ✓ Regulatory framework establishes minimum education standards for digital education to which all actors in education must comply.

☐ Measures to remove barriers to accessing digital content⁴⁵, including ensuring access to curriculum-aligned digital content available on free, public, multi-modal national platforms; high-quality content is available in core subjects, official national language(s), and designed with inclusive features to assist learners with disabilities.

☐ Digital skills incorporated into pre- and in-service teacher and leadership training curricula to create a culture of digital innovation and growth anchored in equity and inclusion that enables ongoing professional development for existing and emerging staff.

- ✓ Future-ready skills (including digital skills, data and AI competencies, critical thinking, etc.) integrated into formal curriculum at all levels of education

☐ Measures address the digital divide, including ensuring access to reliable electricity, meaningful internet connectivity at school and at home, devices suitable for learning and teaching, safe and sustainable software and secure platforms, and integrated education data systems.

☐ A well-established, sustainable, and cost-effective budget secured from a range of funding sources and intersectoral cooperation, supported by impact focused reporting linked to regional strategic goals.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

The Common Core Curriculum of Technical Education and IT Defined on the Learning Outcomes ((Official Gazette of Bosnia and Herzegovina no. 24/16) defines learning outcomes on the level of primary and secondary education.

- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)?

- ✓ Lack of quality, curriculum-aligned digital teaching and learning content that supports flexible learning and teaching pathways
- ✓ Limited access to internet and/or electricity

⁴⁵ Lack of internet connection, basic infrastructure or devices.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Lack of equity and inclusion in digital learning solutions
☐ inadequate safety measures and IT support to respond to issues of child online safety or reduce cyber security risks
☐ Other: | ☒ Difficulty in regulating the use of digital education solutions
☐ Difficulty in sustainably financing digital education solutions at national scale
☒ Lack of digital skills development for meaningful use of digital technology in teaching practice
☐ Disjointed or fragmented solutions that are not centrally systematized or regulated |
|---|---|

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

In accordance with UNICEF sources, in average, in Bosnia and Herzegovina 20 pupils share one computer device, while 583 primary and secondary schools do not have one single device at all.

Not all schools and all classrooms have access to internet and student-computer ratio is still not on desired level. Number of pupils per computer in primary schools in the entity of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina is 19,76 (Institute for Statistics of FBiH. Statistical bulletin no. 368/2023). Number of pupils per computer in secondary schools in the entity of Federation of Bosnia and Herzegovina is 10,07 (Institute for Statistics of FBiH. Statistical bulletin no 361/2023).

Agency for Preschool, Primary and Secondary Education developed a Common core of technical and information curricula and programs defined on the learning outcomes as a framework for the development of subject curricula for technical culture and informatics. Through the achievement of defined learning outcomes, the aim is to train students to apply technical-technological and informational knowledge in everyday life through: building entrepreneurial technical-technological way of thinking and communicating, developing creative and critical thinking, affirming creativity and originality, through systematic thinking and developing a plan for solving problems, practical creation in the realization of own ideas according to a fixed work plan, application of science in technics and technology, through the development of psychomotor skills by mastering the fundamental principles of handling various techniques and managing technological processes, assessment and self-evaluation of learners, building a working attitude to technological development and its significance for the welfare of the individual, society and nature, using technology for creating, storing, organizing, manipulating and inventing digital content, through the development of creativity and social media knowledge, digital society and information technologies, development and application of analytical skills, problem-solving skills and algorithmic thinking, through safe and ethical use of technology in learning and everyday life, which includes the protection of one's privacy and identity on the Internet, i.e. in the digital society, through the selection, use and combination of different software, hardware and network communications on different digital devices to create different digital content needed to meet defined goals. Consideration should be given to the student's prior knowledge as well as the influence of the media and other factors in the student's environment. It ensures balanced and connected upbringing and educational activities through the overall development of students, taking into account,

in addition to information and technological changes, social, economic and other changes in modern life.

4 Strengthening governance systems

For reference: The Education 2030 Framework for Action states "to ensure quality education and conditions for effective education outcomes, governments should strengthen education systems by instituting and improving appropriate, effective and inclusive governance and accountability mechanisms; quality assurance; management information systems; transparent and effective financing procedures and mechanisms; and institutional management arrangements, as well as ensure that robust, timely and accessible data are available" (para. 18).

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked):

☐ Monitoring mechanisms to assess compliance with the right to education obligations, including through management information systems.

☐ Monitoring results are made public. Please provide the link:

☐ Monitoring processes are participatory, inclusive and regular.

✓ Sector-wide and multisector approach is adopted to education governance.

✓ Financial resources are effectively allocated to prioritise the provision of free, quality, public education and are adequately budgeted for in government plans.

☐ The decision-making process for the allocation of resources to education is transparent.

☐ Ensuring crisis-sensitive and disaster risk-informed planning and programming, including the provision of quality education in emergencies.

☐ There is a certain degree of decentralization in favour of local public authorities and autonomy for schools to ensure context relevance of their teaching.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance?

☐ Budgetary constraints

☐ Lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels

☐ Absence of supportive/ inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment

☐ Lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data

☐ Poor dialogue with teachers' trade unions

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

III. Methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments

For reference: UNESCO governing bodies have underlined the need for awareness raising. Given the importance of normative action at the national level, wide dissemination of the Convention must be ensured, with the support of National Commissions for UNESCO.

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked)

☐ Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages

☐ Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education including through appropriate materials and resources

☐ Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments

☐ Other: